Hogar_en

Home The word “home” transcends the mere physical structure of a dwelling to designate a space where a person or a group of people inhabit, generating in them a deep sense of security, belonging and calm. This emotional dimension is what fundamentally distinguishes the home from the concept of "house", a term that is limited to the description of the physical dwelling or the property as such. The origin of the term is intimately linked to ancestral domestic life: it comes from the specific place of the house where the fire was lit, the nerve center around which the family gathered both to obtain heat and to feed itself. By extension, the concept currently applies to residential institutions that seek to replicate that welcoming and protective environment, such as retirement homes, foster homes, or foster homes. demographically and sociologically, the home is conceived as a fundamental socio-economic cell. It is a recurrent statistical unit that is defined based on the organization of people to meet their nutritional needs and other shared vital requirements, regardless of kinship ties. The etymology of “home” is particularly significant. The term derives from the late Latin *focare*, which designated the place of the house where the bonfire was prepared. Over time, this meaning extended to encompass the house itself and, by metonymy, to the family that resides in it. In turn, * focare* derives from *focus* ("fire" or "hearth"), a word that has its roots in the Indo-European root * bζeh■-* ("to shine"). This root should not be confused with the homophone *bha-* (“to speak”). The linguistic connection of *bζeh■-* is clearly seen in Greek, relating with *φζς* (from the genitive *φωτ■ς*, “fôs, fotós”), which means “light”, and with the verb *φα■νω* (*phaíno*), which translates as “to show” or “to bring to light”. The same Indo-European root is present in West German with the term * bauknan * ("lighthouse"), origin of the English word *beacon*. Thus, etymologically, the home remains linked to the idea of light that shines and guides, reaffirming its role as the vital and warm center of the your human existence